Mohenjo-Daro and Harrapan Civilization

Dating to around 5,000 BCE, the Indus Valley Civilization is one of the earliest civilizations to emerge from the Indian sub-continent. It spread through the lower Ganetic Valley area all the way up to Malwa. The urban centers that developed here were much larger compared to modern day towns in other countries. They were strategically laid out in accordance to cardinal points. Buildings were constructed out of mud bricks and mostly fashioned from kilns. Dwellings were built with a courtyard, a front door, a kitchen area and rooms for sleeping. Most family activities were carried out near the front of the home in the courtyard. The houses were similar to what is believed to have existed in the Ancient Middle East, Ancient Rome and Greece.

From this period, the most significant sites are Mohenjo-Daro and Harappa, which can both be found in modern day Pakistan. These sites were both part of India before the country was divided into two separate countries in 1947. The Harrapan Civilization is also known as the Indus Valley Civilization and takes its name from the site of Harappa. It is generally separated into the Early Period (5,000 – 4,000 BCE), Middle Period (4,000 – 2,900 BCE) and the Mature Period (2,900 – 1,900 BCE).

Harappa can be dated to the Middle Period and was established sometime around 3,000 BCE. Mohenjo-Daro was founded during the Mature Period and built around 2,600 BCE. During the 19th century, the British used much of the materials found at Harappa in order to build the railway. Unfortunately, the buildings had been destroyed by the locals of the Harappa Village to construct their own buildings. Archaeologists have had a difficult time performing their excavations because of the destruction caused by both Indians and the British. Little is known except that it was one of the most significant Bronze Age sites with a population of about 30,000 natives.

However, there is more to be learned from Mohenjo-Daro. Until 1922, the ancient city lay buried under the earth. The name can be translated as Mound of the Dead in the Sindhi language. Unfortunately, we do not know